UNIT 36.3 · LEVEL B2

Possibility & deduction (in the past)

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 The window is broken. Someone _____ it with a ball.

a) can't have hit **b)** should hit **c)** must have hit **d)** might hit

2 He _____ the bus; he was at home all day.

a) can't have taken **b)** must have taken **c)** might take **d)** should take

3 I can't find my keys. I _____ them at the office.

a) can't have left **b)** must leave **c)** should leave **d)** may have left

4 The streets are wet. It _____ last night.

a) must rain **b)** must have rained **c)** can't rain **d)** might to rain

5 She didn't answer. She _____ asleep.

a) must be **b)** might have been **c)** could to be **d)** can't be

6 They _____ the news; they looked so surprised.

a) must have heard **b)** may hear **c)** should hear **d)** can't have heard

7 The cake is gone! The kids _____ it.

a) could have eaten **b)** couldn't eat **c)** must eat **d)** might eating

8 You _____ tired after such a long flight.

a) must be having **b)** can't have **c)** must have been **d)** should being

9 Tom _____ the email. He replied right away.

a) can't have read **b)** might read **c)** should read **d)** must have read

10 It _____ Sara at the door; she is in Rome.

a) can't have been **b)** must have been **c)** may be **d)** should have been

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 The ground is wet. It _____ have rained last night.

12 He wasn't at the party. He _____ have known about it.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

13 I don't see my wallet. I _____ have left it at home.

14 She looks happy. She _____ have passed the test.

15 They arrived late. They _____ have missed the train.

16 You _____ have seen Ben; he is on vacation.

17 The thief _____ have come through the window.

18 Mia must have _____ the door open. (leave)

19 They can't have _____ the answer. (know)

20 He might have _____ the wrong bus. (take)

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **She / must / have / forgotten / her / keys.**

_____

22 **He / can't / have / seen / us.**

_____

23 **They / might / have / missed / the / bus.**

_____

24 **It / must / have / rained / last / night.**

_____

25 **You / could / have / left / it / at / school.**

_____

26 **Someone / must / have / taken / my / umbrella.**

_____

27 **The / thief / may / have / used / a / ladder.**

_____

28 **She / can't / have / been / at / home.**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the correct modal.*
The floor is wet. Someone _____ spilled water.
Options: **must have** / **can't have** / **might to have**

30 *Choose the correct modal.*
He _____ been at the meeting; he was on a plane.
Options: **can't have** / **must have** / **should have**

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

31 *Choose the correct modal.*
I'm not sure, but she _____ missed her flight.
Options: **might have** / **must have** / **can't have**

32 *Choose the correct form.*
They must have _____ the whole cake.
Options: **eat** / **eaten** / **eating**

33 *Choose the correct form.*
He can't have _____ the message.
Options: **seen** / **saw** / **see**

34 *Choose the correct modal.*
The door was open. Someone _____ have forgotten to lock it.
Options: **may** / **can't** / **mustn't**

35 *Choose the correct modal.*
You _____ have been very cold without a coat!
Options: **must** / **can't** / **might not to**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each form with its meaning.

1. must have + past participle _____
2. can't have + past participle _____
3. may have + past participle _____
4. could have + past participle _____

A. sure it didn't happen
B. it was an option or ability in the past
C. sure it happened
D. it was possible, but not sure

37 Match each situation with the best sentence.

1. Wet streets this morning _____
2. Anna was abroad yesterday _____
3. You are not sure where your keys are _____
4. The window is open _____

A. Someone could have come in.
B. It must have rained.
C. She can't have been here.
D. I might have lost them.

38 Match each verb with its past participle.

1. take _____
2. see _____
3. go _____
4. know _____
5. write _____

A. seen
B. known
C. written
D. taken
E. gone

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

39 Match each sentence with a similar meaning.

1. She must have left. _____
2. She can't have left. _____
3. She might have left. _____
4. She should have left. _____

A. I'm sure she didn't leave.
B. Maybe she left.
C. She didn't do the right thing.
D. I'm sure she left.

40 Match each wrong sentence to its correction.

1. He must has gone. _____
2. She can't have being there. _____
3. They might have go home. _____
4. You must have saw it. _____

A. They might have gone home.
B. He must have gone.
C. You must have seen it.
D. She can't have been there.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 She must has forgotten her phone. Correct word: _____

42 They can't have being home. Correct word: _____

43 He might have go to the bank. Correct word: _____

44 You must have saw him there. Correct word: _____

45 I may left my keys in the car. Correct word: _____

46 She couldn't have to know about it. Correct word: _____

47 The dog must be ate my homework. Correct word: _____

48 It might have been rained all night. Correct word: _____

49 Tom can't has finished already. Correct word: _____

50 They could have took the wrong road. Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

UNIT 36.3 · LEVEL B2

Answer Key

Possibility & deduction (in the past)

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** must have hit	Must have + past participle = strong deduction.
2	**a)** can't have taken	Can't have = sure it didn't happen.
3	**d)** may have left	May have = a past possibility.
4	**b)** must have rained	Wet streets are evidence.
5	**b)** might have been	Might have been = possible past state.
6	**d)** can't have heard	Surprise suggests they hadn't heard.
7	**a)** could have eaten	Could have = a possibility.
8	**c)** must have been	Must have been = a strong conclusion.
9	**d)** must have read	His quick reply is evidence.
10	**a)** can't have been	She was in Rome, so it wasn't her.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**must** (or: may, might, could)	Must have = strong deduction.
12	**can't** (or: couldn't)	Can't have = sure it didn't happen.
13	**may** (or: might, could)	May have = possible.
14	**must**	Her mood is evidence.
15	**might** (or: may, could)	Might have = possible.
16	**can't** (or: couldn't)	Can't have = impossible.
17	**could** (or: might, may)	Could have = it was possible.
18	**left**	Must have + past participle.
19	**known**	Can't have + past participle.
20	**taken**	Might have + past participle.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**She must have forgotten her keys.**	Must have + past participle.
22	**He can't have seen us.**	Can't have = sure it didn't happen.
23	**They might have missed the bus.**	Might have = possible.
24	**It must have rained last night.**	The wet ground is evidence.
25	**You could have left it at school.**	Could have = possible.
26	**Someone must have taken my umbrella.**	Strong deduction.
27	**The thief may have used a ladder.**	May have = possible.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

28	**She can't have been at home.**	Can't have been = impossible.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**must have**	Evidence leads to a conclusion.
30	**can't have**	He couldn't have been there.
31	**might have**	It is only a possibility.
32	**eaten**	Past participle after have.
33	**seen**	Past participle after have.
34	**may**	A possible explanation.
35	**must**	Strong conclusion about the past.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	must have + past participle – sure it happened; can't have + past participle – sure it didn't happen; may have + past participle – it was possible, but not sure; could have + past participle – it was an option or ability in the past Past deduction has different strengths.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	Wet streets this morning – It must have rained.; Anna was abroad yesterday – She can't have been here.; You are not sure where your keys are – I might have lost them.; The window is open – Someone could have come in. Use the evidence you have.
38	**1-D 2-A 3-E 4-B 5-C**	take – taken; see – seen; go – gone; know – known; write – written Use these participles after have.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	She must have left. – I'm sure she left.; She can't have left. – I'm sure she didn't leave.; She might have left. – Maybe she left.; She should have left. – She didn't do the right thing. Modals change the meaning.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	He must has gone. – He must have gone.; She can't have being there. – She can't have been there.; They might have go home. – They might have gone home.; You must have saw it. – You must have seen it. Use have + past participle.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**must have**	Use must have + past participle.
42	**can't have been** (or: cannot have been)	After have, use the past participle.
43	**might have gone**	Might have + past participle.
44	**must have seen**	Use the past participle: seen.
45	**may have left**	Add have after may.
46	**couldn't have known**	Couldn't have + past participle.
47	**must have eaten**	Past deduction needs have + participle.
48	**might have rained**	Rain is not passive here.
49	**can't have finished** (or: cannot have finished)	Use have, not has, after a modal.
50	**could have taken**	Past participle of take is taken.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.